

Check the SQL Browser service's status via `services.msc` or similar methods.

Remediation:

Enable or disable the service as needed for your environment.

Default Value:

The SQL Server Browser service is disabled if only a default instance is installed on the server. If a named instance is installed, the default value is for the SQL Server Browser service to be configured as Automatic for startup.

References:

1. <https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/sql/database-engine/configure-windows/sql-server-browser-service-database-engine-and-ssas>

CIS Controls:**9.1 Limit Open Ports, Protocols, and Services**

Ensure that only ports, protocols, and services with validated business needs are running on each system.

Appendix: Summary Table

Control		Set Correctly	
		Yes	No
1	Installation, Updates and Patches		
1.1	Ensure Latest SQL Server Service Packs and Hotfixes are Installed (Not Scored)	☒	☐
1.2	Ensure Single-Function Member Servers are Used (Not Scored)	☒	☐
2	Surface Area Reduction		
2.1	Ensure 'Ad Hoc Distributed Queries' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.2	Ensure 'CLR Enabled' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.3	Ensure 'Cross DB Ownership Chaining' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.4	Ensure 'Database Mail XPs' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☐	☒
2.5	Ensure 'Ole Automation Procedures' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.6	Ensure 'Remote Access' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☐	☒
2.7	Ensure 'Remote Admin Connections' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.8	Ensure 'Scan For Startup Procs' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.9	Ensure 'Trustworthy' Database Property is set to 'Off' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.10	Ensure Unnecessary SQL Server Protocols are set to 'Disabled' (Not Scored)	☒	☐
2.11	Ensure SQL Server is configured to use non-standard ports (Scored)	☒	☐
2.12	Ensure 'Hide Instance' option is set to 'Yes' for Production SQL Server instances (Scored)	☐	☒
2.13	Ensure the 'sa' Login Account is set to 'Disabled' (Scored)	☐	☒
2.14	Ensure the 'sa' Login Account has been renamed (Scored)	☐	☒
2.15	Ensure 'xp_cmdshell' Server Configuration Option is set to '0' (Scored)	☒	☐
2.16	Ensure 'AUTO_CLOSE' is set to 'OFF' on contained databases (Scored)	☒	☐
2.17	Ensure no login exists with the name 'sa' (Scored)	☐	☒
3	Authentication and Authorization		

3.1	Ensure 'Server Authentication' Property is set to 'Windows Authentication Mode' (Scored)	☒	☐
3.2	Ensure CONNECT permissions on the 'guest' user is Revoked within all SQL Server databases excluding the master, msdb and tempdb (Scored)	☒	☐
3.3	Ensure 'Orphaned Users' are Dropped From SQL Server Databases (Scored)	☒	☐
3.4	Ensure SQL Authentication is not used in contained databases (Scored)	☒	☐
3.5	Ensure the SQL Server's MSSQL Service Account is Not an Administrator (Scored)	☒	☐
3.6	Ensure the SQL Server's SQLAgent Service Account is Not an Administrator (Scored)	☒	☐
3.7	Ensure the SQL Server's Full-Text Service Account is Not an Administrator (Scored)	☒	☐
3.8	Ensure only the default permissions specified by Microsoft are granted to the public server role (Scored)	☒	☐
3.9	Ensure Windows BUILTIN groups are not SQL Logins (Scored)	☒	☐
3.10	Ensure Windows local groups are not SQL Logins (Scored)	☒	☐
3.11	Ensure the public role in the msdb database is not granted access to SQL Agent proxies (Scored)	☒	☐
4	Password Policies		
4.1	Ensure 'MUST_CHANGE' Option is set to 'ON' for All SQL Authenticated Logins (Not Scored)	☒	☐
4.2	Ensure 'CHECK_EXPIRATION' Option is set to 'ON' for All SQL Authenticated Logins Within the Sysadmin Role (Scored)	☐	☒
4.3	Ensure 'CHECK_POLICY' Option is set to 'ON' for All SQL Authenticated Logins (Scored)	☒	☐
5	Auditing and Logging		
5.1	Ensure 'Maximum number of error log files' is set to greater than or equal to '12' (Scored)	☒	☐
5.2	Ensure 'Default Trace Enabled' Server Configuration Option is set to '1' (Scored)	☒	☐
5.3	Ensure 'Login Auditing' is set to 'failed logins' (Scored)	☒	☐
5.4	Ensure 'SQL Server Audit' is set to capture both 'failed' and 'successful logins' (Scored)	☒	☐
6	Application Development		
6.1	Ensure Sanitize Database and Application User Input is Sanitized (Not Scored)	☐	☐
6.2	Ensure 'CLR Assembly Permission Set' is set to 'SAFE_ACCESS' for All CLR Assemblies (Scored)	☐	☐
7	Encryption		

7.1	Ensure 'Symmetric Key encryption algorithm' is set to 'AES_128' or higher in non-system databases (Scored)	☒	☐
7.2	Ensure Asymmetric Key Size is set to 'greater than or equal to 2048' in non-system databases (Scored)	☒	☐
8	Appendix: Additional Considerations		
8.1	Ensure 'SQL Server Browser Service' is configured correctly (Not Scored)	☒	☐

Appendix: Change History

Date	Version	Changes for this version
07-2017	1.0.0	Initial Release